

RETAILNEXT X OPENAI

HELPING CUSTOMERS FIND EVENT OUTFITS THAT ARE ACTUALLY IN STOCK.

RetailNext shoppers arrive with an occasion, a deadline, and often a specific store in mind. This briefing shows how OpenAI can help interpret that brief while RetailNext keeps control of product, inventory, price, and fulfilment decisions.

CUSTOMER

event-ready outfits with store availability shown before the visit

ASSOCIATE

clear handoff notes, item rationale, and substitution paths

BUSINESS

visibility into missed demand, low stock, and failed missions

RETAILNEXT IS LOSING HIGH-INTENT SHOPPERS WHEN STYLE DISCOVERY AND LOCAL AVAILABILITY ARE DISCONNECTED.

The pattern from reviews is clear: customers struggle to find current styles or confirm that specific items are available in store for upcoming events. That affects conversion, store workload, and confidence in the RetailNext experience.

CUSTOMER SIGNAL "I know the occasion." Customers describe intent: a wedding guest look, a first-day outfit, a last-minute party, or something current in store.	FRICTION POINT Search and inventory answer separately. A relevant recommendation can still fail if the item is unavailable locally, unsuitable for the event, or hard to complete as a basket.	BUSINESS IMPACT Failed missions become poor reviews. High-urgency shopping journeys create lower tolerance for friction, more associate lookup time, and less visibility into missed demand.
LOST CONVERSION high-intent shoppers abandon when availability confidence is low	MANUAL LOOKUP associates bridge style, stock, substitutes, and customer messaging	BRAND TRUST poor reviews compound when store discovery falls short of the digital promise

PEOPLE SHOP WITH INTENTION. SEARCH OFTEN STARTS WITH KEYWORDS.

Event-based shopping includes context that a short query rarely captures: formality, weather, season, colour, budget, urgency, and whether the look can be found in a local store today.

TRADITIONAL SEARCH

BLACK DRESS

Returns product matches, then leaves the shopper or associate to work through event fit, complementary items, substitutes, and availability.

INTENT-LED SHOPPING

SMART OUTFIT FOR A WINTER WEDDING IN NEW YORK

Uses the full shopping brief to retrieve relevant products, check store stock, and explain a complete outfit.

STRATEGIC SHIFT

The same shopping brief can support search, stock checks, associate handoff, and follow-up. That is where the demo is focused.

RETAILNEXT EVENT STYLIST CONNECTS THE CUSTOMER BRIEF WITH CATALOGUE, STOCK, AND NEXT ACTIONS.

The prototype builds on the OpenAI clothing RAG cookbook and adds the retail checks an executive demo needs. OpenAI helps interpret the shopper's request; RetailNext systems decide what is eligible, available, affordable, and appropriate to show.

UNDERSTAND Interpret item image, event, style, budget, store, and urgency	RETRIEVE Use embeddings to find catalogue candidates by event and product meaning	GROUND Apply SKU truth: inventory, price, role, budget, fulfilment, and substitutes	ACTIVATE Render basket, preview chat changes, brief associates, and trigger lifecycle follow-up
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WHAT OPENAI DOES

Makes shopper intent usable by the application.

Vision analysis, structured outputs, semantic search queries, chat-to-action reasoning, shopper explanations, and guardrail review.

WHAT RETAILNEXT CONTROLS

Keeps final control of what is shown and sold.

Only catalogue SKUs are recommended. Price, stock, budget, fulfilment, substitutions, basket mutation, and CRM delivery stay deterministic.

THE LIVE APP MAKES THE BUSINESS CASE VISIBLE IN ONE SHOPPER JOURNEY.

The demo starts from a selected or uploaded starter item, builds a complete outfit for an event, then shows the same session becoming a basket, a store handoff, and a demand signal.



CUSTOMER

Complete look with store confidence

The shopper sees fit scores, item rationale, price, and local stock before travelling to a store.



ASSOCIATE

A clearer handoff

Mira summarises why the outfit works, which items are low stock, and what substitutes protect the basket.



BUSINESS

A usable signal from failed searches

Unmet event intent and stock gaps become inputs for allocation, buying, clienteling, and recovery workflows.

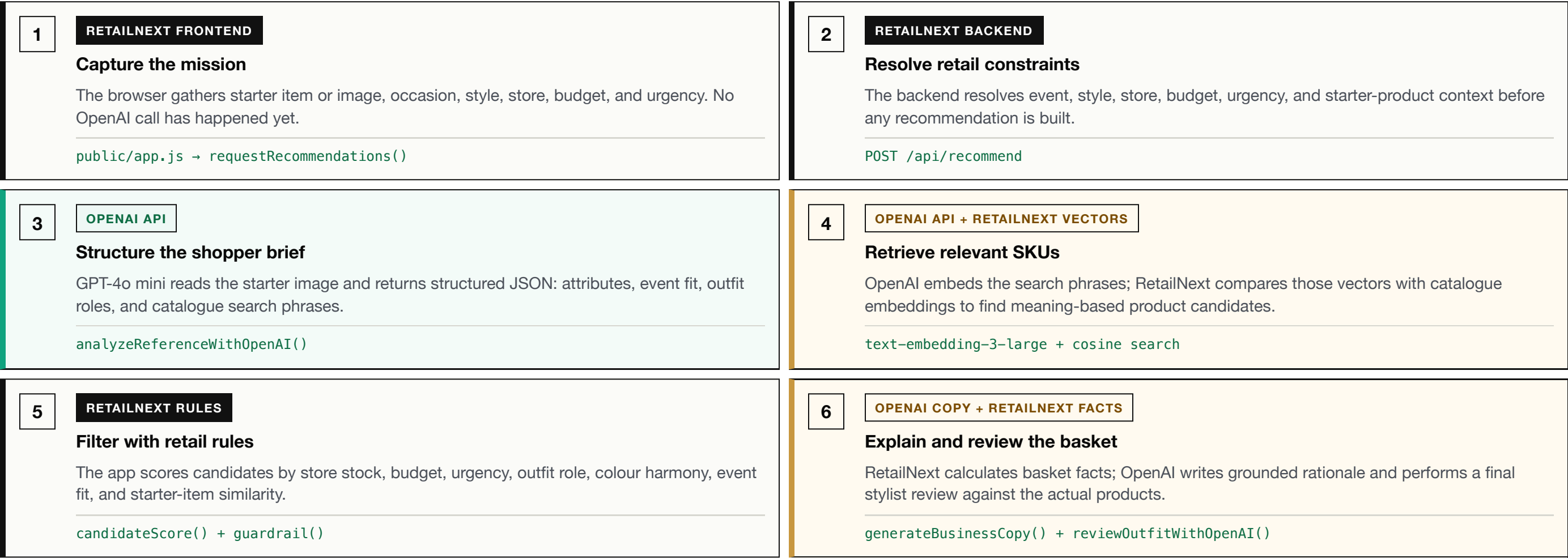
WHEN THE CUSTOMER CLICKS GENERATE OUTFIT, OPENAI PROPOSES AND RETAILNEXT VERIFIES.

The flow keeps OpenAI focused on interpretation and language, while the app checks SKU, price, stock, budget, and fulfilment rules.

RETAILNEXT OWNED

OPENAI API

OPENAI + RETAILNEXT



Show the validated result

The customer sees products, availability, rationale, Mira chat, and add-to-basket prompts based on the server-validated response.

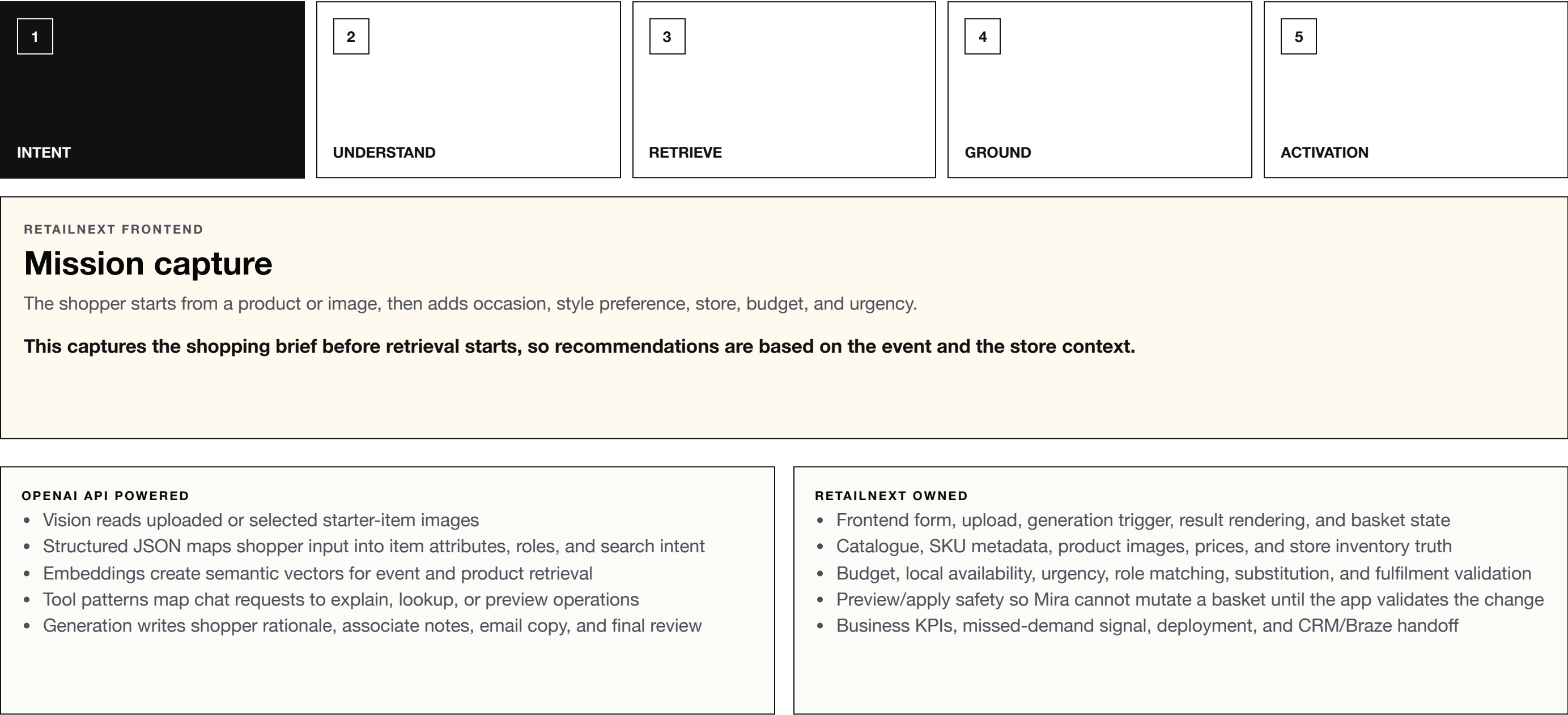
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renderResult()
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IMPORTANT BOUNDARY

OpenAI provides interpretation, retrieval intent, rationale, and language. RetailNext owns catalogue data, SKU eligibility, price, inventory, fulfilment rules, basket state, and the final response shown to the shopper.

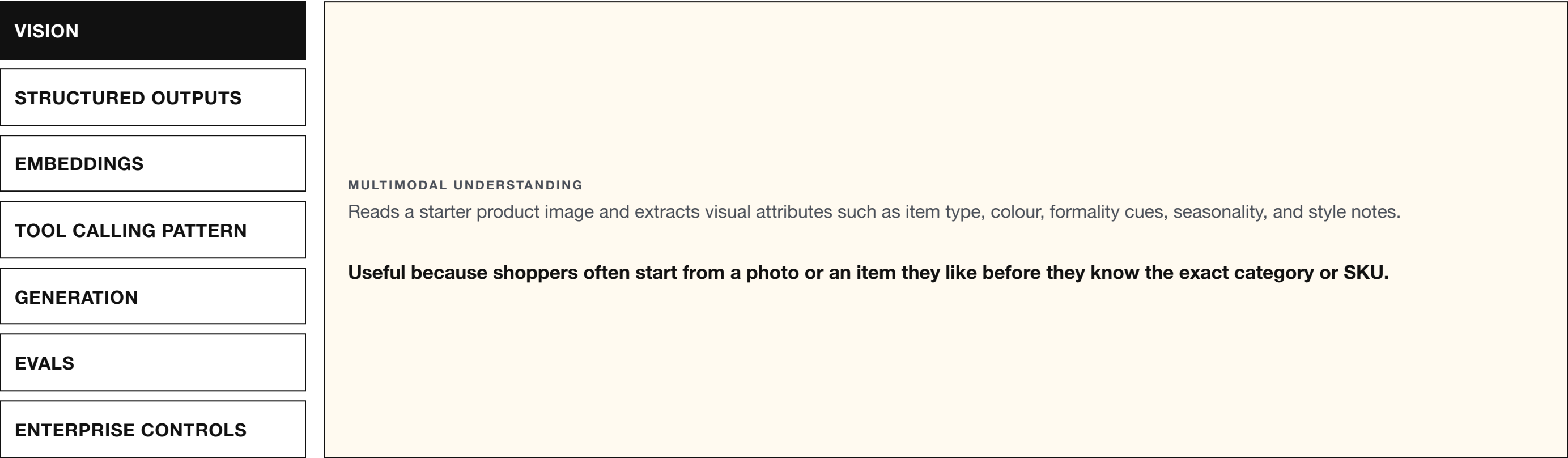
OPENAI SUPPORTS INTERPRETATION. RETAILNEXT KEEPS CONTROL OF RETAIL FACTS.

Click through the flow to show which components use OpenAI and which remain controlled by RetailNext application logic.



OPENAI IS A STRONG FIT BECAUSE THE WORKFLOW USES SEVERAL CAPABILITIES TOGETHER.

RetailNext needs image and text understanding, semantic retrieval, structured integration, action safety, reliable generation, and a practical evaluation path.



INTENT GPT-4o mini vision + structured shopping brief	RETRIEVAL text-embedding-3-large semantic catalogue search	ACTIONS Responses-style tools explain, lookup, preview, email	GOVERNANCE Evals + app guardrails availability truth and hallucination checks
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THE VALUE IS FEWER FAILED SHOPPING JOURNEYS, STRONGER BASKET CONFIDENCE, AND BETTER STORE EXECUTION.

Use the stakeholder toggle to frame the same solution for the Head of Innovation or CTO.

HEAD OF INNOVATION

CTO

HEAD OF INNOVATION LENS

This is a customer-facing use case with a clear journey: the shopper gets a complete outfit, and the same session can support stores and follow-up messaging.

- Improves event shopping on top of the existing product search experience.
- Creates a visible assisted-selling moment across digital and store channels.
- Links review themes to specific points to measure across merchandising and operations.

EXPERIENCE

Fewer dead-end journeys

Customers see event fit and local availability before travelling to store.

REVENUE

Stronger event conversion

Complete outfits and substitute options protect attachment because the customer sees a workable basket.

OPERATIONS

Less manual lookup

Associates get the item list, rationale, inventory context, and backup options in one place.

PLANNING

Demand signal

Unmet event intent and stock gaps become inputs to transfer and replenishment decisions.

START WITH A NARROW PILOT, MEASURE THE JOURNEY, THEN EXPAND.

This lets RetailNext prove value while the technical controls mature.

30 DAYS

Crawl: validate demand

Pilot wedding guest, work event, and vacation journeys. Measure completed baskets, availability rate, refinement prompts, and feedback.

60 DAYS

Walk: integrate operations

Connect PIM, POS inventory, OMS fulfilment, preferences, Braze messaging, and associate workflows for selected stores.

90 DAYS

Run: harden and scale

Add evals for outfit coherence, substitution quality, availability truth, latency, cost, complaint rate, and conversion confidence.

CLOSING LINE

"A strong first version should connect three things clearly: what the customer wants, what is available nearby, and what the business can do next."